

The New Grammar of LUXURY

New buyers, higher prices, and a growing appetite to trade up are powering India's luxury market. But the expansion is uneven, its consumers acutely price-sensitive, and its shape distinctly Indian

BY **PRADIP K. SAHA**

GHAS A weakness for sunglasses. They are all around her: Dior, Bvlgari, Chanel, Cartier, Celine, Fendi, Prada, Gentle Monster. A couple of pairs sit in her BMW X7, one is clipped to her Fendi bag at home, and a few others lie around the house. Still, when she saw the large, square Loewe pair on a US vacation a few months ago, she couldn't resist.

"I have probably 20 pairs and didn't need another. But I did not have the shape and the brand," says the 41-year-old former actor. "I had to have this one. It is big on my face, but I like it." She paid ₹78,000 for the shades.

Not all her purchases are impulsive. "Like when I went for my daughter's birthday to Paris, I knew I

- HIGH GOLD PRICES ARE CHANGING JEWELLERY HABITS, PUSHING BUYERS TOWARDS SMALLER PIECES, LOWER-KARAT GOLD AND LAB-GROWN DIAMONDS
- NEW-GENERATION START-UP FOUNDERS, CREATORS AND YOUNGER BUYERS ARE CHANGING WHAT LUXURY MEANS, AND WHICH CATEGORIES ARE IN DEMAND
- BUYERS ACROSS PRICE BANDS REMAIN ACUTELY PRICE-SENSITIVE, COMPARING DOMESTIC PRICES WITH OVERSEAS ALTERNATIVES BEFORE PAYING